

SEWV Support Knowledge Base — 04: Tools, Glossary & Open Items

Tools in use

- **Gmail** — shared support inbox. Each teammate has their own label/folder (plus subfolders like "high priority," "low priority," "reference/informational," "training"). Tag a teammate's label + remove "Inbox" label to route something to just their folder.
- **Teachable** — course platform/LMS. Manages student accounts, purchases, subscriptions, enrollments, coupons, refunds (within 30 days).
- **Kit** (old name was **ConvertKit** — occasionally still referenced that way by accident) — email marketing platform. Core concepts:
 - **Tags** = mark what someone has purchased/joined/opted out of (e.g. membership tag, cancel tag, "Doesn't want SC promo," "Testimonial").
 - **Sequences** = automated multi-email series triggered by a tag (e.g. "WBC Daily Email," "LC4 Daily Emails," "PV Daily Emails: Promo"). Removing someone's tag does not always remove them from an in-progress sequence/automation — sometimes requires going into the automation itself and removing them individually (no bulk option currently).
 - **Broadcasts** = one-off manual sends (e.g. weekly newsletter, monthly promotions) — don't retroactively reach people who joined after the send date.
 - **Automations** = the visual workflow connecting a trigger tag → filters → tag changes → sequence enrollment → follow-up actions. Used e.g. for FFC onboarding / course onboarding, and the welcome automation for new subscribers. (The old Monthly Membership lesson-unlock automation no longer exists — see the "discontinued" notes in [01-email-response-playbook.md](#) and [02-admin-task-procedures.md](#).)
 - Optional Chrome browser extension shows a subscriber's tags directly in Gmail.
 **Only works when logged into the main Gmail account directly (with its actual password)** — it does **not** work for anyone with **delegated access** to the inbox (Norah, Laura, and Amber all have delegated access). **Resolved as of July 14, 2026: Ailsa confirmed she no longer uses it** — it doesn't show the information she actually needs. Treat this extension as not currently part of the workflow.
 -  **Claude has live, direct Kit API access (confirmed July 27, 2026)** — not just the Chrome extension. Claude can look up subscribers by email, check tags, check engagement (opens/clicks/delivery) on specific broadcasts and sequence emails, list sequences/broadcasts, and apply tags. This means Claude can verify things like "did this student actually receive the payment reminder" before making claims in a reply (see the Recurring/subscription charge template in

[06-phrase-express-exact-templates.md](#) for a worked example). Each tool call requires the person's approval in this interface.

-  **Gmail draft tool cannot attach files** (confirmed July 27, 2026) — despite an "attachments" field existing in the tool's schema, it's explicitly marked as not yet supported. So templates that say "I'll attach a photo" can't literally do that yet. **Workaround:** if Vanessa shares a Drive folder of reference screenshots, Claude can link directly to a specific image in the email body instead (student clicks the link to view it) — not a true attachment, but functionally similar. **To do:** Vanessa to share a reference-screenshots Drive folder; once available, update [06-phrase-express-exact-templates.md](#)'s "attach a photo" mentions to use direct image links instead.
- **Stripe** — primary payment processor; also where payment-dispute/chargeback evidence would get submitted, **but we no longer do this** (see Procedure I in [02-admin-task-procedures.md](#) — disputes are just deleted/ignored now rather than contested). Used for refunds on purchases **older than 30 days** — at that point Teachable's built-in refund button no longer shows within Teachable, so the refund has to be done directly in Stripe instead.
- **PayPal** — secondary payment processor, common with international students. **Cannot be used for subscription payments** — a student cannot pay for the Monthly Membership or Yearly Membership with PayPal (PayPal only works for one-time-payment products). Used for refunds on purchases **older than 30 days** (paid via PayPal) — at that point Teachable's built-in refund button no longer shows within Teachable, so the refund has to be done directly in PayPal instead.
- **Zapier** — automation layer connecting Teachable ⇌ Kit (e.g. auto-canceling old Monthly payments on a Lifetime upgrade). **Known to be imperfect** — always manually double-check the Kit side after a Teachable change.
- **Phrase Express** — text-expander used for the team's canned/pre-written reply snippets (e.g. typing "sorry" auto-expands into the standard payment-decline apology).  **Not yet in this knowledge base** — see Open Items below.
- **Monday.com** — internal task tracker; "Important Links" tab holds the promotion schedule/calendar.
- **Promotions calendar spreadsheet** ("Promotions: Speak English With Vanessa," Google Sheets) — the master promo calendar, with a tab per year. The **2026 tab** is current; each row covers a specific promo window (dates, course, price, checkout link, coupon code, order bump, upsell, theme, Kit segment to send). **October, November, and December 2026 aren't finalized yet** — treat those as tentative. This is a **live reference to check, not something to copy into this knowledge base** (it changes often) — worth checking here if a student's email seems to reference a specific promo/discount, to confirm what's actually running and quote the right price/link. Link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/11bsBRUw6_3u6CydUq9Fg9EnLRaQXZz04Pxz-wdKoE0I/edit
- **Canva** — used to generate completion certificates for challenges (e.g. WBC).

- hi@yourteacher.ai (**Peter**) — external paid support vendor specifically for Vanessa AI app technical issues. Route Vanessa-AI-app bugs here rather than solving internally.
- **Course sign-in page:** https://speak-english-with-vanessa.teachable.com/sign_in — general link for any "how do I log in" / "forgot password" situation, not just Procedure E.

Team & roles

- **Vanessa** — owner/instructor. Final say on judgment calls, custom discounts, old/ambiguous refund requests, and anything outside the standard playbook.
- **Ailsa** — senior VA / trainer. Author of most existing tutorials; day-to-day inbox lead.
- **Amber** — English-content teacher; handles grammar/pronunciation-specific student questions.
- **Norah** — VA assistant; the account this knowledge base is onboarding. Works every weekend, and also fills in when Ailsa is on vacation. Handles inbox duties and whatever admin tasks stem directly from what's happening in the inbox (not broader project/admin work beyond that).
- **Laura** — copywriter and project manager; has delegated access to the inbox. **Status is in flux (not finalized):** currently working through the next two weeks, but likely taking a break for the month of August while these Claude-based systems get set up — if they work out well, her role may or may not continue afterward. Some of her copywriting/project-management tasks may migrate to Norah (e.g. Norah writing promotions, adding them to Kit, and potentially running some projects) — none of this is decided yet, just flagging the possibility.

Glossary / naming conventions

- **FFC** = Fearless Fluency Club (flagship product/brand).
- **FFC 3.0** = current Monthly Membership structure (superseded the old separate level-course system as of July 1, 2024).
- **MM** = Monthly Membership.
- **LC1–LC5** = the five individual 30 Day Listening Challenge packs. **Internal shorthand only** ("LC1," "LC2," etc., and Kit tags like "LC5: Receive emails") — use this for admin/tag purposes. **When talking to a student, use the theme name instead** — e.g. "the 30 Day Listening Challenge: Passion" or "the 30 Day Listening Challenge: Activities" — so students studying out of numeric order don't feel like they're "missing" earlier packs. Kit tags include both the number and the theme (e.g. "LC2 Family"), and theme names have been rebranded over time, so double-check which theme currently maps to which number rather than assuming.
- **PV** = Phrasal Verb challenge; **VC** = Vocabulary challenge (both components of the 90 Day English Challenge).
- **WBC** = Word-Boosting Challenge (the 60-day one).
- **SC / SC1 / SC2** = Speaking Challenge. Plain "SC" internally usually means the **original** challenge (SC1, launched end of 2022/beginning of 2023, sold a few times since). **SC2**

is the current version (launched July 2026), integrated with Vanessa AI — customer-facing name is **"30 Day Speaking Routine."**

- **"Free Opt-in"** — Kit tag applied the **first time** someone downloads any free lead magnet (e.g. the free ebook "5 Steps to Becoming a Competent English Speaker"). Triggers the welcome sequence/automation. Only applied once ever — if they later download a different freebie, they don't get this tag again or restart the automation.
- **"Finished Freebie"** — Kit tag applied when someone **completes the welcome automation** (not simply when they download something). Once tagged, they move into the general pool that receives broadcasts (weekly newsletter, monthly promotions). While someone is still in the welcome sequence (i.e. doesn't have this tag yet), they receive **only** the welcome automation emails — no other marketing/broadcast emails at all.
- **"No Promos: In FFC 3.0 Automation"** — temporary Kit tag applied to brand-new FFC students during their onboarding period, which suppresses *all* other marketing/promo emails (including things like the Vanessa AI SAVE70 push) so new students stay focused on FFC onboarding content only.
- **Modules** (current term — "lesson set" is outdated, though it occasionally still comes up) — the ~40 topic-based FFC modules (e.g. Meditation, Public Speaking, Money, Love, Cars, Therapy, etc.), each containing several lessons (this is why marketing says "248 lessons" rather than counting modules — customers don't necessarily know what a "module" is, but "lessons" is clear). All modules are available to every Monthly Membership, Yearly, and Lifetime student automatically (no monthly unlock/rotation anymore). **New modules are added 3 times per year** to everyone's account automatically the moment they launch — not something mentioned in marketing, just a way of keeping the content fresh. Students don't need to do anything to get them; they just show up automatically when logging in.
- **2026 Study Plan:**
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1RQmK_z48Y83lfJxSoP_GxJgfqzi5nmmh/view?usp=sharing — names the current "featured" module and includes its direct link. This is the reference to use when a student asks what to study next / what the current module is — safe to send this link **directly to the student in an email** (it's not just for internal reference; students can already see this info when logging in, but sending it directly is a helpful shortcut).

Next phase — now live (confirmed July 27, 2026)

- **The Claude Gmail label namespace is built and live.** Final structure, created by Vanessa:
 - **Claude/Need sent** — the customer-facing reply draft goes here (create as a Gmail draft, `replyToMessageId` set to the original message, then apply this label to the thread).
 - **Claude/Need admin (high priority)** — for anything needing backend admin work (Kit/Teachable/Stripe/PayPal). Use the two-draft pattern below.

- **Claude/Need deleted** — delete candidates (replaces the earlier "To Be Deleted" placeholder name).
- **Claude/Possible unsubscribe** — for senders who should probably be unsubscribed (replaces earlier planning notes on this).
- **Claude/Possible spam** — replaces the earlier "To Be Marked As Spam" placeholder name.
- Whoever is on duty (Ailsa or Norah) works through these **Claude/*** folders to see everything that's been processed — rather than emails silently showing up mixed into their personal folders.
- **Two-draft workflow (the actual daily process).** The goal: an admin says "write drafts for all emails" once at the start of the day, and never needs to interact with Claude again to see what to do — everything lives in Gmail. For any email needing backend admin work, Claude creates **two separate drafts on the same thread** (via `replyToMessageId`):
 1. **The customer reply** — addressed to the student, ready to send as-is. Label the thread **Claude/Need sent**.
 2. **The admin checklist** — `to` field left **completely empty** (so Gmail blocks accidental sending), subject clearly marked e.g. "🔧 ADMIN TASKS — DO NOT SEND," and the body contains the **fully written-out steps** (not a pointer like "see Procedure J") — pulled from the relevant procedure(s) in `02-admin-task-procedures.md` and filled in with that student's actual details (amounts, tags, dates), so the admin can just follow it top to bottom with zero cross-referencing. Label the thread **Claude/Need admin (high priority)** instead of/in addition to **Claude/Need sent**.
- For emails that are delete-candidates, possible-spam, or possible-unsubscribe (no draft needed): just apply the matching **Claude/*** label directly to the thread, no draft required.
- **Timeline: July 27 – August 2, 2026 is the trial/testing window** for this whole project — inbox drafting, labeling, all of it. Expect heavy editing of these knowledge base files during that week as real cases come up.
- **Possible refinement (to work out later, not decided yet):** nest sub-labels under **Claude/Need admin (high priority)** by action type — e.g. "Need admin/Unsubscribe in Kit," "Need admin/Kit Tag Needed" — so an admin can batch similar tasks together instead of handling one at a time in a flat list. Worth deciding on the exact sub-label set once we see how many distinct action types actually show up in practice.
 - **Actual current Gmail label structure (documented July 13, 2026):**
 - **Per-person folders:** **AILS**A, **NORAH**, **VANESSA**, **Amber** — each with sub-labels like "High Priority" / "Low Priority" (matches the priority system in `00-overview-and-workflow.md`) and "Reference/Informational." **AILS**A also has "Drafts to be reviewed" and "Emails corrected" sub-labels.

- **Admin Archive** — created by Vanessa on July 13, 2026, consolidating what used to be several standalone labels into nested sub-labels underneath it. Purpose: reference/record-keeping labels for things that don't need regular checking — kept in case of future reference. Matches the "label applied after handling an email" pattern described earlier. **These are currently applied manually by the VA. Claude can apply these labels directly** (has the Gmail tooling to do so) **but the VA should still double-check/review** rather than treating it as fully hands-off — this isn't fully autonomous yet.
 - **Certificate** — applied after sending a student their completion certificate for finishing a 30 Day Challenge (**any of them except the Speaking Challenge**). Trigger: the challenge's final email asks the student to reply describing their experience (essentially a testimonial) in exchange for the certificate; once we've sent it, the email gets this label so there's a record that it was actually sent.
 - **Opportunities** — brand/collab pitches that are language-related and Vanessa finds genuinely interesting even though she's not doing it, or feature-announcement emails from Kit/Teachable that seem potentially useful but there's no time to evaluate right now. (See playbook entry #18 for the broader collab-pitch policy — most of those get deleted outright; this label is for the minority that are worth a second look later.)
 - **Payment** (and its nested **Canceled Subscription, Failed Billing Attempt, Disputes, SC Refund Sent**) — **fully automatic**, not manually applied. These are Gmail filter/settings rules that auto-route matching incoming emails directly into these folders — no VA or Claude action needed to sort them.
 - **Payment/SC Refund Sent** — specific to a **January** promo run of the original Speaking Challenge (SC1), which had a "finish all 30 days + meet a couple other criteria → get a refund" hook. Applied when one of those refunds was sent, so it could be double-checked/confirmed later. This is a one-off historical promo mechanic, not a general SC refund process.
 - **Taxes** — **fully automatic**, not manually applied. A Gmail filter auto-labels incoming emails from the tax accountant (George Austin), the payroll accountant (Kristen King), or occasionally other tax-related senders with both **Taxes** and the **VANESSA** label, then removes them from the inbox entirely — they go straight to Vanessa and the VA never sees them.
 - **Testimonial** — applied manually (currently by Ailsa, Claude can do this too) when a student's message contains language that could work as a marketing testimonial — positive, specific, emotional, shows a transformation. Comes up most often in the

certificate-request emails (see [Certificate](#) above), since students describe their course experience there, but can apply to any email. See also the cross-product policy note in [03-products-pricing-and-current-promos.md](#).

- **Vanessa AI** — largely obsolete now. Was used for past promotions; current workflow forwards Vanessa AI support questions straight to Peter at hi@yourteacher.ai instead (see the strict support-routing rule in [03-products-pricing-and-current-promos.md](#)). Still exists for manually saving something if needed, but expected to be used rarely going forward.
- **Zoom Summary** — **fully automatic**, not manually applied. A Gmail filter/setting automatically routes auto-generated Zoom call summaries (from the Speak English With Vanessa Zoom account) into this label.
- **FFC: 7-Day FF** — used for tracking Day 4 replies during the now-retired "verify before giving personalized speaking review" policy (see playbook entry #27). **Confirmed no longer needed** as of July 14, 2026, though a few students may still receive the old speaking summary for about a week during the transition.
- **ADMIN / Admin: Reference** — **resolved as of July 14, 2026**: these have been moved under [Admin Archive](#), per Ailsa's confirmation.
- **AILSA/Ailsa: Drafts to be reviewed** and **AILSA/Ailsa: Emails corrected** — leftover from when Ailsa was training Norah. **Resolved as of July 14, 2026**: Ailsa confirmed these could be deleted, and they've been removed.
- **AILSA** (the plain top-level label, not a sub-label) — general tagging: low-priority emails, or anything Vanessa tags her into during an internal back-and-forth conversation. Ailsa then decides herself whether to escalate something into [AILSA/High Priority](#).
- **AILSA/High Priority** — emails Ailsa has personally deemed high priority that she needs to answer; applying this label pulls them out of the shared inbox into her folder specifically so no one else deals with them.
- **AILSA/Reference/Informational** — Ailsa's personal reference folder, generally back-and-forth messages about policy changes. **Nothing for Claude/the VA to do with this one** — it's for Ailsa's own use.
- **Amber** (the plain top-level label) — general emails for Amber that aren't specifically pronunciation, e.g. vocabulary question review, general homework help ("help me with my vocabulary sentences").
- **Amber/Amber Pronunciation** — for anything about pronunciation practice/lessons specifically. Low volume (~4-5/month). Claude can auto-apply this label based on subject/content pattern-matching against past examples in this folder, without needing an explicit rule beyond

"pronunciation-focused content → Amber." **Note:** the line between plain **Amber** and **Amber/Amber Pronunciation** isn't strictly important — Vanessa isn't sure Amber even needs them kept separate and will check with her.

- **NORAH** (the plain top-level label) — general tagging for things Norah needs to look at. Since she only works **Saturday/Sunday** (plus filling in when Ailsa is on vacation), things that come up during the week get tagged to her here so she can work through them on the weekend.
- **NORAH/1. High Priority** and **NORAH/2. Low Priority** — her own self-chosen initial filtering when she checks the inbox (similar pattern to Ailsa's High Priority label).
- **NORAH/Admin Emails** — appears old, likely dating back to her initial onboarding; probably not important/actively used anymore.
- **NORAH/Reference/Informational** — new policies etc. that she needs to review.
- **NORAH/TeacherAI** — also appears old; probably not important/actively used anymore.
- **SEWV Newsletter** — intended to catch **replies to any email sent via Kit** (newsletter/broadcast/promo replies), via a Gmail filter setting, so they're separated from the main inbox. Not a perfectly reliable filter — some of these still land in the general inbox instead. **Inbox philosophy:** the main inbox is meant to surface the more urgent items first — random contact-form submissions and people emailing directly — while Kit-newsletter replies get diverted to this label instead. Not necessarily important for Claude to treat specially, since Claude will be checking the inbox generally regardless. ⚠ **Known current issue:** some Stripe emails are incorrectly landing in this label due to a Gmail filter setting from June — Vanessa is working on fixing this now.
- **VANESSA** (the plain top-level label) — receives things automatically via Gmail settings (e.g. Monday.com notification emails), plus anything Ailsa or Norah manually flag as something Vanessa needs to be aware of.
- **VANESSA/5-Minute Emails** — purpose unclear even to Vanessa; **being removed**. Don't build anything around this label.
- **VANESSA/Vanessa Informational** — Vanessa's personal miscellaneous "might need this later" bucket — used to save an email conversation (often between students) that doesn't cleanly fit one of the **Admin Archive** categories. High volume, loosely organized by design.
- **VANESSA/Vanessa: Archive** — a nested folder structure used historically for hiring (candidate applications, teacher applications, teacher audio submissions, etc.).
 - **Vanessa: Archive/Vanessa: TEAM** — previously used for internal team communication; Vanessa has since moved to just emailing the plain **VANESSA** label directly instead, so this is

intentionally meant to stay unused going forward. **However:** if anything does end up here, it should **also** get the plain **VANESSA** label applied, since Vanessa might not think to check the nested Archive folder regularly and could otherwise miss it.

- Before building this, it's a good opportunity to **tidy up the existing Gmail label structure** (current labels are per-teammate folders like Ailsa's — worth deciding on a clean label taxonomy for priority/status before automating against it).

Open items / gaps in this knowledge base

1. **Phrase Express phrases — resolved July 27, 2026.** Ailsa sent over the "Phrase express 1.0" doc; it's been incorporated into [05-voice-guide-and-additional-scenarios.md](#) (voice patterns + new scenarios), with outdated pricing/product references flagged rather than used. Worth a periodic re-check if Ailsa's phrase library gets updated again in the future.
2. **Procedure B (Kit non-member cleanup) — Zapier automation test.** Currently being tested as a replacement for the manual monthly cleanup process. Check back in ~45 days (from July 12, 2026, so roughly late August) to confirm whether it's working reliably; if not, Procedure B's manual steps (kept for reference in [02-admin-task-procedures.md](#)) may need to come back.
3. **Vanessa AI SAVE70 coupon — seasonal only.** Scheduled to run in September; should not be mentioned/offered outside its active window. Worth double-checking each time it reopens (dates may shift year to year) rather than assuming September indefinitely.
4. **Vanessa AI SAVE70 promo — case-by-case edge case, not a standard playbook entry.** Students with the temporary "No Promos: In FFC 3.0 Automation" tag won't receive the SAVE70 / "30 Days, 30 Conversations" promo emails at all (by design — this tag suppresses all marketing during onboarding). The only way they'd buy anyway is finding it directly (e.g. YouTube), expected to be rare — if it comes up, tag Vanessa rather than treating it as scripted.
5. **New standalone Vanessa AI promotion — planned for August, not run before.** This is a new/untested promo (separate from SAVE70). No FAQ sheet exists yet. **To do once the FAQ sheet is created:** add it to [03-products-pricing-and-current-promos.md](#) (pricing, coupon code, checkout link, refund policy) and cross-reference it from the playbook as needed.
6. **Confirm [VANESSA/5-Minute Emails](#) label has been removed** — Vanessa said she'd remove it since its purpose was unclear; verify it's actually gone.
7. **Teachable connection for enrollment verification — blocked, Windows not supported.** Tried installing the official Teachable MCP Bundle (July 27, 2026) — it's currently **Mac-only** (confirmed both in Teachable's own documentation and by the installer's own OS check on Vanessa's Windows machine). Vanessa has messaged Teachable support asking about Windows support plans/timeline. **For now, all Teachable-dependent checks stay manual** — this includes the Zoom Room enrollment gating in [06-phrase-express-exact-templates.md](#), checking current

course enrollment, and checking cancellation/refund status. Once Windows support exists (or Mac access becomes available), revisit this to build out: course enrollment lookups, checking if a student's already been canceled from FFC, and checking refund-issued status — these would meaningfully speed up several of the playbook/procedure entries that currently require a manual Teachable check.

8. **Confirm the Stripe/SEWV Newsletter filter issue is actually fixed** — Vanessa attempted a fix (possibly related to a June filter setting) but wasn't sure it worked; double check Stripe emails are landing in the right place now.
9. **Reference-screenshots Drive folder needed.** Since Claude's Gmail draft tool can't attach files, several templates in `06-phrase-express-exact-templates.md` say "I'll attach a photo" — once Vanessa shares a Drive folder of the reference screenshots, update those templates to link directly to the relevant image instead.

Addendum — Labeling workflow corrections (confirmed July 27, 2026)

Fold this into `04-tools-glossary-and-open-items.md`, under the "Next phase — now live" section, replacing/updating the two-draft workflow description.

Corrected two-draft / labeling rule

Previous (incorrect) understanding: any thread needing backend admin work would get *both* `Claude/Need sent` and `Claude/Need admin (high priority)` applied together.

Corrected rule, per Vanessa's direction:

- **No backend action needed** (pure reply, nothing to look up/change/refund) → apply `Claude/Need sent` only.
- **Backend action needed** (refund, Kit tag change, Teachable lookup, coupon creation, etc.) → apply `Claude/Need admin (high priority)` only — do **not** also add `Claude/Need sent`.
 - Reasoning: the admin checklist draft already contains the fully-written customer reply as part of the two-draft pattern. The admin handles the backend steps *and* sends the ready-made customer draft as part of completing that checklist. A separate `Need sent` label would just duplicate the same task across two folders.

Remove **INBOX** label the moment a draft is created

As soon as *any* draft is created on a thread (customer reply, admin checklist, or both), remove the **INBOX** label from that thread immediately, in the same pass. This keeps the general inbox showing only unprocessed items, and everything already drafted lives exclusively in the relevant **Claude/*** folder(s).

This does **not** apply to delete/spam/unsubscribe-candidate threads that get only a label with no draft (e.g. **Claude/Need deleted**, **Claude/Possible spam**, **Claude/Possible unsubscribe**) — no explicit instruction yet on whether to also pull those out of **INBOX**; flag to Vanessa if that's desired too.

Scope: only act on threads from the last 30 days

Confirmed with Vanessa: the daily drafting/sorting workflow only applies to threads with activity **within the past 30 days** (**newer_than:30d** in Gmail search syntax). The general inbox has years of old, already-resolved, or personal/internal threads sitting in it (old collab threads, invoices, hiring correspondence, personal messages, old Circle/Teacher AI bug reports, etc.) that were never cleared out — these are **out of scope entirely**. Do not label, draft, or otherwise touch anything older than 30 days; leave it exactly as-is. This applies across every **Claude/*** folder destination and every source folder (general inbox, **SEWV Newsletter**, etc.) — always scope searches to the last 30 days before processing.

If Vanessa or a teammate wants the old backlog cleaned up at some point, that would be a separate, explicitly-requested project, not part of the regular daily workflow.

Known bug: editing a draft with **update_draft** can detach it from its thread

Discovered July 27: calling **update_draft** on an existing draft (to fix wording, add a name, etc.) sometimes silently detaches the draft from the original email thread — it ends up as an orphaned standalone thread instead of staying attached to the conversation it was replying to. This happened at least twice in one session (Othman's refund reply, Michael's cancellation reply) and wasn't obvious until Vanessa reported "there's no reply on that thread."

Rule going forward: never use **update_draft to fix an existing customer-facing or admin-checklist draft.** Instead, recreate it fresh with **create_draft** + **replyToMessageId** set to the original message, then edit the old broken draft's subject/body to something like "DISREGARD — superseded/duplicate" so it doesn't get confused with the correct one or accidentally sent. This costs one extra draft floating around but guarantees the real reply stays properly threaded, which matters more.

Match the reply to the exact ask — don't assume cancellation means refund or vice versa

Two corrections in one session came from replying with the wrong template because the underlying ask wasn't read carefully enough:

- A student asked only to confirm their subscription was canceled ("so I am not charged again") — no mention of a refund. The reply and admin checklist were drafted as a refund case by mistake. Corrected back to a plain cancellation (Procedure A only).
- A different student's message ("I want to cancel the payment," replying to a "[NOTICE] Payment coming soon" reminder) was actually a refund situation per Vanessa's read of it, matching file 06's "Recurring/subscription charge confusion — refund" template — the first draft had treated it as cancellation-only.

Rule: re-read the specific wording of what the student is asking for (cancel only vs. refund vs. both) before picking a template, rather than pattern-matching on subject line or general vibe. When genuinely ambiguous, it's fine to ask Vanessa/Ailsa rather than guess.

Every reply opens with "Hi [Name]," — including template-based replies

Confirmed July 27: every customer-facing reply should start with "Hi [Name]," (or "Hi there," if no name is available), with no exceptions. This includes the Day 4 / Day 6 onboarding templates in file 06, which show the template body starting directly with "Thanks for sharing..." — that's just how the doc excerpts the reusable part; a "Hi [Name]," greeting still needs to be prepended when actually drafting the reply. Several Day 4 replies and a few quick boundary-redirect replies (WhatsApp/Instagram asks, etc.) were sent this session without a greeting — worth spot-checking any of those still in **Need sent**.

"Long and heartfelt" hardship — calibration and rarity

Confirmed July 27: the "long, heartfelt hardship → warm reply + Doesn't want promos tag" exception (playbook #19) should be reserved for messages of roughly **10+ sentences/lines**, and should come up **rarely**. A few sentences of context ("I'm jobless, sorry, I want to learn but can't pay") is not enough on its own — that stays in the default-delete bucket even if it's not a bare one-liner. Three cases were miscalibrated this session and corrected back to **Need deleted**.

Paying students asking about "other weekly meetings" and "which module should I study" — important, reply in detail

Confirmed July 27: when a paying student (identifiable by replying to a course email — Day 4/6 onboarding, etc.) asks (a) whether there are other weekly meetings besides the official Sunday Live Lesson / Fearless Fluency Chats, and/or (b) which module/lesson they should study next or what level it's at — these are important questions and deserve a detailed, specific reply, not a brush-off.

Template:

Yes, there are other weekly meetings in the club beyond the official ones. In the Facebook group, you can click on the Events tab to see which other events are happening. Not all students post their events there though, so it's also worth scrolling down through the group feed to see what's been posted. If you ever need help finding one, just tag me in the Facebook group and I'll tag you in the various calls that are happening.

As for studying an extra lesson: all of the modules in the club are at a similar intermediate/advanced level, so there isn't a strict order you need to follow. My recommendation is to start with the Roadmap first, and I'd also point you to our [2026 Study Plan](#), which shows which module we're studying together each month. After that, if you're looking for something specific to study next, feel free to email me anytime and I can suggest a module that fits what you're working on. You also already have access to all the modules in your account, so you're welcome to explore on your own too.

Both the "Events tab" mention and the "2026 Study Plan" link (hyperlinked, not raw URL) should be included whenever this question comes up.

Vague one-line newsletter replies with no context — no reply, even if it sounds like a complaint/question

Confirmed July 27: if someone is replying to a **course-related email as a paying student** (e.g. a Day 4/6 onboarding email, a live-lesson reminder, a worksheet/PDF confirmation, a receipt), it's worth replying even to a short message, since there's real context tying it to their account/course experience. But if someone replies to a **general newsletter/marketing broadcast** with just **one line and no context** (e.g. "this is not working," with no detail on what "this" is or why they'd be a paying student), that does NOT need a reply — route to [Claude/Need deleted](#), even though it superficially reads like a question or complaint. Don't ask a clarifying question in these cases; just delete.

Only reply about age/eligibility if someone is specifically asking about buying a course

Confirmed July 27: anyone can study with Vanessa's free content (YouTube, email lessons, PDFs) regardless of age — there's no age restriction on the free material. **Only bring up age/eligibility in a reply if the person is specifically asking about purchasing a course.** If a young student (or anyone) writes in without asking about buying anything — just sharing enthusiasm, saying they're a student, asking a general question — treat it under the normal rules (course-recommendation default, or delete if there's no real ask) rather than replying about age. Don't volunteer an age-based decline where it wasn't asked for.

Beginner tips + 50% off Beginner course — use sparingly

Confirmed July 27: new template for students who are clearly beginners and express genuine enthusiasm. **Use sparingly — only when someone writes at least 3 sentences AND mentions they're a beginner AND says something kind (e.g. enjoying the lessons/videos).** Casual one-line "I want to learn English" messages do NOT qualify for this template — those still follow the standard course-recommendation default (file 06 #16) or get deleted per the usual rules.

Template (corrected July 27):

Hi [Name],

Thank you so much for your kind words! Starting as a beginner is such an exciting step.

To get you started, I'd recommend this video: [Beginner English Lesson](#).

If you'd like structured, step-by-step support as a beginner, I also have a beginner course, and I'd love to offer you 50% off to get started: [The Beginner English Course](#).

I hope that helps. Keep up the good work with English!

Vanessa English Teacher www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com

Formatting notes:

- The course's actual name is **"The Beginner English Course"** (not "Beginner Fearless Fluency Club") — use this as the hyperlink text.

- Capitalize "Beginner English Lesson" (it's a title) but keep "beginner course" lowercase when referring to it descriptively in the sentence ("I also have a beginner course").
- Put a period immediately after each hyperlink to properly end the sentence.

Both links should be hyperlinked text, not raw URLs.

Personal contact requests (WhatsApp, Instagram, phone number, visa/immigration help, or general "let's chat personally") — no reply, just delete

Confirmed July 27: Vanessa does not respond to requests for WhatsApp, Instagram, a phone number, or **visa/immigration/"help me move to the US" requests** — these all fall into the same "too personal/out of scope" category. This also extends to any message that's generally too personal/unprofessional in nature (e.g. "I want to talk to you," wanting personal chat outside of email), not just these specific channels. These get filed as "too personal" → route straight to **Claude/Need deleted**, no boundary-redirect or decline-template reply needed (this replaces the earlier approach of sending a polite decline template for visa requests — don't send that anymore, just delete).

General principle: when uncertain, erring toward **Need deleted** is the safer default

Confirmed July 27: since Vanessa reviews the **Need deleted** folder every day anyway, it's a lower-cost mistake for something to accidentally land there than to end up in **Need sent** or **Need admin** with a wrong or unnecessary draft. When genuinely unsure whether a message needs a reply, default toward **Need deleted** rather than drafting speculatively.

Students from Bangladesh, Pakistan (and usually India) — never offer a paid course, default delete

Confirmed July 27: students who mention being from Bangladesh or Pakistan typically don't have payment access, so **never offer a paid course** (FFC, Vanessa AI, Beginner course, etc.) to them. India is usually the same situation. **Default action: route to Claude/Need deleted, no reply.**

The one exception: if they specifically say they can't download/access the **free PDF** — that's something everyone should have access to regardless of payment ability, so that's still worth a genuine reply (troubleshooting the download, per the usual free-PDF template). Any other kind of message (wanting to learn, asking about courses, general enthusiasm) from these countries gets no reply.

Recognizing "lesson guide" requests by module theme name

Confirmed July 27: FFC lessons are organized into monthly themed modules (e.g., "Adoption"). When a student mentions a theme name and asks for a PDF/worksheet/guide, they're asking for the **lesson guide** for that specific themed module — not a generic worksheet.

Signals that a message is this type of request:

- The student is replying to an FFC/course-specific email (a live-lesson email, a module announcement, a Sunday class recap) — not a general marketing newsletter.
- They name a specific theme/topic (e.g. "the adoption lesson," "today's class about X") rather than asking generically.
- They ask for "the PDF," "the sheet," "the guide," or similar, tied to that theme.

When these line up, point them to the "FILES" section of the Facebook group's menu, where lesson guides for each themed module are stored — that's the standard answer, not the general Worksheet Library or a "check your confirmation email" response (those are for the separate free-PDF-signup context, a different scenario).

Proofreading/correction requests — only for FFC-specific practice, not outside writing

Confirmed July 27: Vanessa does not proofread or correct writing that's unrelated to FFC course material — reports, personal documents, emails for work/school, etc. Students sometimes take advantage of this if it's offered once, so hold the line consistently. **The only exception:** if the student is specifically practicing vocabulary or phrasal verbs they learned in an FFC module (look for phrasing like "I'm practicing the new vocabulary/phrasal verbs I learned in this module"), it's fine to give feedback on those specific sentences.

Decline template (outside-FFC writing):

Hi [Name],

Thanks for your email! I'm not able to give feedback on writing that's outside of the Fearless Fluency Club material, like reports, documents, or other outside writing, since that's a bit outside of what I'm able to offer each student individually. If you're practicing specific vocabulary or phrasal verbs from a module in the club, I'm happy to take a look at sentences using those instead.

I hope that helps. Keep up the good work with English!

"Code" in FFC context usually means the Facebook group secret code

Confirmed July 27: when a student mentions "the code" in relation to the FFC, this almost always refers to the **secret code** they need to include when requesting to join the private Facebook group (i.e. "English is fun," per the existing Facebook group instructions) — not a coupon/discount code. Don't assume "code" means a discount code (like 30OFF/THANKS) unless the context is clearly about checkout/pricing.

Grammar: comma splice self-check — required before finalizing every draft

Confirmed July 27 (reinforced further after multiple instances slipped through, including recurring ones after the rule was already noted): comma splices have shown up repeatedly across drafts this session, so a passive "watch for it" reminder isn't enough — add an explicit self-check step.

Before sending any draft, re-read every sentence and check each comma individually with this test: cover up everything before the comma, and everything after it. If BOTH halves could stand alone as a complete sentence, it's a comma splice. Fix it one of three ways:

1. Split into two sentences (period + capital letter): "...genuinely hard. Please be gentle with yourself."
2. Add a coordinating conjunction after the comma: "...genuinely hard, so please be gentle..."
3. Use a semicolon if the two clauses are closely related: "...genuinely hard; please be gentle..."

This check should be a distinct final pass over the drafted text — not just something to keep in mind while writing — since these have been getting missed even when the general rule was already known.

"No bank account" is a variation of "I have no money" — route to delete

Confirmed July 27: messages citing "I don't have a bank account" as the reason they can't pay should be treated the same as the standard "I have no money"/"I can't afford it" pattern — route to **Claude/Need deleted**, no reply, same as other can't-pay variations. Don't treat "no bank account" as a distinct payment-method question needing a workaround suggestion.

"I stopped receiving [course emails]" — check Kit before assuming a technical glitch

Confirmed July 27: when a student says they've stopped receiving a specific email sequence (e.g. the 5-minute daily practice emails), don't default to a generic "check your spam folder" reply. Route to [Claude/Need admin](#) and check Kit for (1) whether they're still an active paying member, and (2) whether they're still subscribed to that specific sequence — the likely cause is an accidental unsubscribe-from-this-sequence click (many sequences have an "I don't want these anymore" link on individual emails), not a real delivery/technical failure.

Two-option draft format for uncertain FFC membership cases

Confirmed July 27: when a thread lands in [Claude/Need admin](#) specifically because FFC membership status couldn't be confirmed via Kit, draft **one single email containing both possible versions**, clearly separated and labeled, rather than a single hedged/conditional reply. This makes it immediately clear to the admin why the thread landed in [Need admin](#) and lets them pick the right version to send after checking Teachable, deleting the other.

Format:

ADMIN NOTE — Two versions below depending on Kit/Teachable membership confirmation. Kit lookup showed no membership tag on her account, which is why this landed in Need admin — please confirm her actual status in Teachable and send the matching version, deleting the other.

===== IF [SHE/HE] IS an FFC member =====

[full reply assuming membership, with member-specific info like the Facebook group code or weekly Zoom calls]

===== IF [SHE/HE] IS NOT an FFC member (just on the mailing list) =====

[full reply for a non-member — general course recommendation instead of member-specific info]

This is a single draft (not two separate drafts), placed as the customer-facing draft on the thread — no separate short admin checklist needed in addition, since the note at the top already explains the situation.

1:1 lesson requests — correct offer order (Vanessa AI, then FFC, iTalki only if they push back)

Confirmed July 27: when a student asks for private 1:1 lessons, the reply should offer, in this order:

1. **Vanessa AI** first (unlimited speaking practice, available anytime), hyperlinked to its sales page.
2. **The Fearless Fluency Club** second, specifically mentioning the weekly Zoom group calls (Fearless Fluency Chats) as the human-connection option, hyperlinked to the sales page.
3. **iTalki** — do NOT mention this upfront. Only bring it up if the student comes back specifically saying something like "I still really want to talk with a human teacher 1-on-1" after the first reply.

Updated template (no iTalki mention):

Hi [Name],

Thanks for your email. I'm so glad you're interested in learning English with me! While I don't offer private 1:1 lessons, I do have something that might be an even better fit: Vanessa AI! It's my AI conversation partner, available anytime day or night, so you can get unlimited speaking practice with instant feedback on your grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation. It's like having a personal tutor without the scheduling. You can check it out [here](#).

If you'd like some human connection too, The Fearless Fluency Club includes weekly Zoom calls where you can talk with me and other students as a group. You can check it out [here](#).

I hope that helps. Keep up the good work with English!

Facebook group replay location — corrected wording + image link

Confirmed July 27: the previous phrasing "look for 'Media' then 'Videos' at the top of the Facebook group" should be updated. On mobile, the group only shows "Videos" (not "Media" then "Videos" as separate steps) — so the correct wording is "**Media**" or "**Videos**" (varies by device), not a two-step sequence. Include this image showing exactly where to click, hyperlinked ("Here's a picture"):

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1MEpVO6PS1cXi0hfF2H8tgxAUPBOpbmJk/view?usp=sharing>

This wording/link should be used consistently anywhere the Facebook group replay location is mentioned (live-lesson troubleshooting replies, Day 6 replies mentioning recordings, etc.) — several replies earlier in this session used the old two-step "Media then Videos" phrasing without the image and should be corrected if they come up for review again.

"I cannot take \$X every month... I did not opt for it" = implicit cancellation request

Confirmed July 27: when a student frames a billing question as a complaint they can't sustain ("I cannot take \$34 every month," "I did not opt for this"), that combination — inability/unwillingness to keep paying + framing the charge as unwanted/unauthorized — should be read as an **implicit cancellation request**, not just a request for clarification. Don't only explain the pricing mechanics; also go ahead and cancel the membership (route to [Claude/Need admin](#), Procedure A), and mention in the reply that the account has been canceled. Contrast this with a purely curious/neutral clarification question (e.g. "just confirming the price is \$35/month, right?") which doesn't need this treatment.

Discontinued program: Pronunciation Intensive / Speaking Intensive (small group)

Confirmed July 27: Vanessa used to run a "Pronunciation Intensive" and "Speaking Intensive" program in a small-group format (Yuki was a participant, May-June 2026). This program has since been discontinued. If a student — especially Yuki, but potentially others who were part of it — mentions missing "direct communication in a small group," personal/human connection from a program, or references something similar to this that doesn't match current offerings, **this discontinued program is very likely what they're referencing**. In a reply, it's worth naming this directly (that the small-group format isn't currently offered) and redirecting to what's currently available instead (the Sunday Facebook live lesson + Fearless Fluency Chats on Zoom).

Verify FFC membership via Kit Purchases before finalizing Day 4/6 or other membership-assuming replies

Confirmed July 27: Day 4/Day 6 onboarding-style replies (and similar) shouldn't automatically assume the recipient is a paying FFC member just because they're in that email sequence — the same welcome/onboarding sequence can also reach people who only joined the general mailing list. **Check Kit** (`Kit:list_subscribers` by email, with `include: [ "tags" ]`) for a purchase/membership tag before finalizing. If a membership tag is found, proceed normally. **If nothing is found, route to Claude/Need admin** with a checklist to confirm actual status in Teachable, rather than assuming either way — draft the customer reply as usual so it's ready to send once confirmed.

Verify FFC membership before sharing the Facebook group secret code

Confirmed July 27: don't assume someone is an active FFC member just because their message implies it (e.g. mentioning "the audios," "the exercises," wanting to talk to "other members"). **Check Kit first** (`Kit:list_subscribers` by email, with `include: ["tags"]`) for a membership tag (e.g. "FFC 3.0"/"FFC Purchased") before including the private Facebook group's secret code in a reply. If no tag is found, don't share the code — route to [Claude/Need admin](#) with a checklist to confirm actual membership in Teachable (Kit tags can occasionally be out of sync), and word the customer reply conditionally ("if you're an active member...") rather than assuming access.

Any reply giving more course info should include a "click to join here" sales page link

Confirmed July 27: whenever a reply explains more about a course (pricing details, how billing works, level fit, etc.) — even if the student didn't explicitly ask "how do I join" — include a line like "You can click to join here: [here](#)" so there's always an easy path to purchase. This applies broadly, not just to direct "tell me about the course" questions — e.g. a pricing-clarification reply, a level-fit reply, a payment-method reply, etc. should all include this link if the underlying course hasn't already been purchased.

Which link to send: sales page by default, checkout link only when specifically asked

Confirmed July 27:

- **Vanessa AI:** anytime Vanessa AI is mentioned or promoted in a reply, always include a hyperlink to the sales page: [Vanessa AI](#)
- **The Fearless Fluency Club (FFC):** anyone asking for more info / wanting to join should be sent the **sales page** (www.speakenglishwithvanessa.com/fluency), hyperlinked — NOT the direct checkout/purchase link.
- **The only exception:** send the direct checkout page (the teachable.com/purchase?product_id=3505735&couponcode=300FF link) specifically when someone says they can't find the checkout page — i.e. they already know they want to join and are having trouble locating where to actually pay.

This is a change from earlier in the session, where the direct checkout link was used as the default for course-recommendation replies — going forward, default to the sales page link instead.

Writing style: proper sentence punctuation, and avoid idioms/advanced phrases for ESL readers

Confirmed July 27, two style corrections:

1. **Sentence boundaries need proper punctuation and capitalization.** A run-on like "...the currency situation that's a very real and fair reason..." should be split into two proper sentences: "...the currency situation. That's a very real and fair reason..." — check that every new sentence starts with a capital letter and the previous one ends with a period.
2. **Avoid idiomatic/advanced phrases, since the audience is ESL students who may not understand them.** Example flagged: "I hope things ease up for you soon" — this idiom ("ease up") is too advanced/unclear for many ESL readers. **Don't try to simplify or rephrase these idioms — just cut the sentence entirely** rather than including an idiom-based phrase in a different form. Keep wording plain and literal throughout.

"Where's my free PDF" template — updated to include spam/promotions check

Confirmed July 27, updated wording:

Thanks for your email, I'm so glad you're excited to learn! Your free PDF worksheet should be inside the confirmation email you received after signing up, just click the download button there. Please check your SPAM and PROMOTIONS folders, too.

If you can't find it, let me know and I'll help you track it down.

I hope that helps. Keep up the good work with English!

Always check the full thread history, not just the first/triggering message

Confirmed July 27: a thread can have multiple back-and-forth messages, including replies Vanessa already sent herself. Drafting a reply based only on the first message in a thread — without checking whether there's already a human reply and a further follow-up from the student — risks answering a stale question instead of the actual open one. **Always pull the full thread (get_thread) before drafting, and reply to the most recent unanswered message specifically**, not just whatever message initially surfaced in a search.

Billing discrepancy (\$ amount higher than expected) — check for an order bump in Teachable

Confirmed July 27: if a student says they were charged more than the stated price (e.g. "\$35 membership showed as \$50"), check Teachable for whether they accidentally purchased an order bump/add-on alongside the main product — this is a common, easy-to-miss cause. This requires an actual Teachable lookup, so route to [Claude/Need admin](#), not [Claude/Need sent](#), even if a currency-conversion explanation also seems to account for some of the difference.

"Please get my written approval before charging me again" — explain the membership is automatic

Confirmed July 27: if a student says they want written/manual approval before future charges, explain that The Fearless Fluency Club is a monthly membership that renews automatically each month — there's no manual approval step before each charge, that's just how the subscription works. If they're comfortable continuing under that setup, no action is needed; if not, they're welcome to cancel anytime.

Distinguishing "I have no money" (new lead) from "I need to cancel/refund" (existing customer)

Confirmed July 27: misspellings are NOT a reliable signal here (English proficiency has nothing to do with whether someone already purchased). Better signals, roughly in order of reliability:

1. **What they're replying to.** A reply to a promotional/marketing broadcast (a sales pitch, "\$1 Offer," a general newsletter) → almost certainly a prospect who never purchased; "can't pay" just means declining the offer → [Claude/Need deleted](#). A reply to a transactional email (a receipt, "[NOTICE] Payment coming soon," a renewal notice) → likely an existing account; "can't pay" could be a real billing/hardship situation → may need [Claude/Need admin](#).
2. **Explicit account language.** Phrases like "my subscription," "my membership," "cancel my account," "I already joined," or an order ID/reference number → existing customer. A prospect declining an offer usually just talks about wanting to join, not an existing account.
3. **The actual verb used.** "Cancel," "refund," "stop charging me" → action on an existing account. "I want to join but I can't afford it" / "I wish I could" → aspirational, never purchased.

4. **When still genuinely unclear:** look the email address up in Kit (subscriber tags/purchase history) to check for an active membership before guessing from wording alone.

Default toward **Claude/Need deleted** when none of these signals clearly point to an existing account.

"Send me books" vs. "book recommendations" — different handling

Confirmed July 27: if someone asks to be **sent** books/PDF books directly (e.g. "can you send me some books to read"), that's a no — route to **Claude/Need deleted**, no reply needed.

If someone is instead asking for **book recommendations** (e.g. "what books should I read to improve my English?"), reply with a link to Vanessa's Amazon book recommendation list, hyperlinked:

If you're looking for book recommendations, I have a list of books I recommend here: [Amazon list](#)

"Re: A quick question" — multiple different broadcasts share this subject line, check content not just subject

Confirmed July 27: several different Kit broadcasts use the same or similar subject line ("A quick question," "A quick question 🕒"), so replies to them land in the inbox looking identical by subject alone but are actually answering completely different prompts. **Always check the quoted broadcast content in the thread, not just the subject line, before deciding how to handle a reply.**

One specific variant to watch for: the broadcast containing the line **"What topic would you love to study in The Fearless Fluency Club?"** is asking students to suggest future lesson topics, not a general check-in. For replies to this specific prompt:

- **If the student lists 4 or more topics:** apply the **VANESSA** label so she can review the suggestions herself — do not delete.
- **Otherwise (1-3 topics, or vague/single-word answers):** route to **Claude/Need deleted** as usual — no reply needed, this isn't a support question.

Asking for price in Rupees signals "can't pay" — route to delete

Confirmed July 27: when a message's main content is asking to convert the price into Rupees (e.g. "how much rupees would I pay per month?"), treat this the same as a "can't pay" signal —

route to **Claude/Need deleted** rather than replying with a detailed pricing breakdown. This is a recognized pattern, not a genuine ready-to-buy pricing question.

Refund replies — don't lead with "I sent you a reminder email" by default

Confirmed July 27: the file 06 "Recurring/subscription charge confusion — refund" template includes the line "I sent you an email reminder a few days ago to let you know that the payment date was coming soon." **This line should NOT be included by default**, even when the student is in fact replying to that reminder email. Including it by default reads as subtly pointing a finger ("you should have known, I did warn you"), which isn't the tone Vanessa wants.

When to include it: only when the student's message itself raises the "why was I charged" confusion — e.g. "why did you charge me again," "I didn't know this was a subscription/membership," or similar surprise/confusion about the charge happening at all. In that specific case, gently clarifying that a reminder was sent is relevant context. Otherwise, leave it out.

Default refund reply, most of the time — exact wording (confirmed July 27):

Thank you for your email. It's no problem to refund your money. I refunded your purchase, and you should receive the money in 5-10 days. I hope this helps. If you have any questions, feel free to ask.

(Prepend "Hi [Name]," and the standard footer as always — this is the body text only.)

Reserve the fuller "you signed up for an automatically renewing membership... I sent a reminder..." version specifically for the confusion/surprise case described above.

Footer link formatting

Exact format to use going forward, on every new draft: the footer link text should read exactly www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com, hyperlinked to <https://www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com>. Full standard footer:

Vanessa

English Teacher

www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com (hyperlinked to <https://www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com>)

How to apply it: set both `body` (plain text, footer line just reads "www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com" with no raw `https://` in front, to reduce the chance Gmail auto-wraps it in its own tracking redirect) and `htmlBody` (with a real `<a href="https://www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com">www.SpeakEnglishWithVanessa.com</a>` tag) on every new draft created via `create_draft`.

Known limitation (July 27): an earlier attempt at this fix didn't reliably hold — at least one draft still showed Gmail's ugly `https://www.google.com/url?q=...` tracking-wrapped link despite `htmlBody` being set correctly. That attempt was tangled up with the thread-detachment bug above (both happened via `update_draft` on an existing draft), so it's not fully confirmed whether `htmlBody` itself is unreliable or whether editing-in-place was the actual cause. Since the standing rule is now "always use `create_draft` fresh, never `update_draft` on existing drafts," this should be retested cleanly going forward. For today, Vanessa is fixing footers manually as she reviews each draft.

Use hyperlinked text for links, except the Teachable sign-in link

Confirmed July 27: going forward, all links in drafts should be inserted as hyperlinked text (e.g. "YouTube," "here," "click here to join") rather than a raw visible URL — set via `htmlBody` with a real `<a href>` tag, per the footer-link approach above. This matches the existing standard format rule in file 00 ("insert links as hyperlinked text... not as a raw pasted URL") — now confirmed to apply consistently, including this session's fixes to YouTube links, checkout links, etc.

Note: Gmail wraps every outgoing link (including Vanessa's own sent mail) in its own click-tracking redirect regardless of formatting — that's normal Gmail behavior, not something wrong with the draft. The fix is only about what text is *visible* to the reader (hyperlinked words instead of a long raw URL), not about removing Gmail's underlying redirect, which isn't possible.

Exception: the Teachable sign-in link

(`https://speak-english-with-vanessa.teachable.com/sign_in`) should stay as a **plain, visible URL**, not hyperlinked text — Vanessa wants students to be able to easily see, copy, and save/bookmark this specific link for future logins, which is harder to do if it's hidden behind hyperlinked text like "here."

Draft creation order for two-draft threads — customer draft should be created last

Confirmed July 27: when a thread has two drafts (customer-facing + admin checklist), Gmail's thread view appears to surface whichever draft was created/modified most recently as the primary/visible one — the other draft is still there (visible in the main Drafts folder, and correctly threaded) but collapsed/hidden until the visible one is deleted.

Vanessa's preference: the student-facing draft should display first, since the admin checklist is a follow-up action, not the primary thing to see when opening the thread. **Rule going forward: create the admin-checklist draft first, then create the customer-facing draft second (last)**, so the customer draft ends up as the most recently created one and displays as primary.

New known constraint: admin-checklist drafts can't have a blank "To" field

The Gmail draft tool requires at least one recipient — it rejects a fully empty **to** field, which the original spec called for (as a safety mechanism against accidental sends to the student).

Workaround in use: set the admin checklist draft's **to** field to

contact@speakeenglishwithvanessa.com (the inbox's own address) as a safe placeholder, so an accidental send loops back into the inbox rather than reaching the student.

Subject stays  **ADMIN TASKS – DO NOT SEND** as originally planned. Worth deciding if there's a better placeholder (e.g. a dedicated internal address) once this comes up for review.